"SICK" SCAPULA

Background

- **S**capular malposition, **I**nferior medial border prominence, **C**oracoid pain, and Dys**K**inesia of scapular movement (SICK) is when your shoulder blade moves out of its normal position during shoulder movement.
- SICK scapula is caused by imbalances or weakness in the muscles around the shoulder blade..
- SICK scapula is commonly caused by repetitive overhead motions like throwing or swimming.
- Pain onset is typically slow and gradual and starts at the front of the shoulder. There's usually no specific injury event.
- Without intervention, SICK scapula can lead to compression of the rotator cuff muscles and increased risk of further injury.

Latest Research

- Most research does not associate this finding with specific injuries, but it can indicate underlying or future problems.

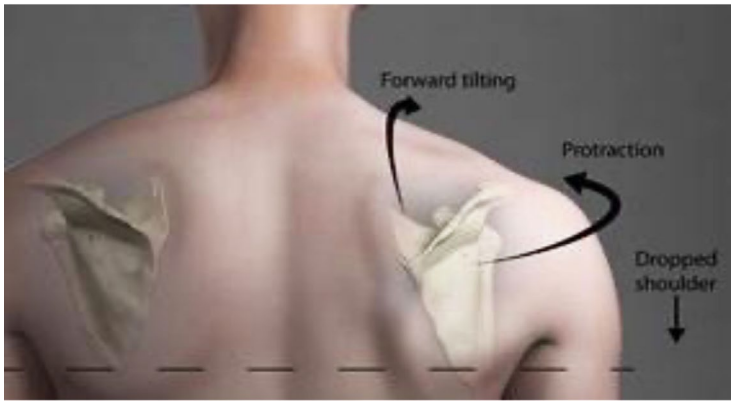


**Diagram taken from https://www.shoulderdoc.co.uk/article/930. Copyright by statpearls.com. All Rights Reserved.

Rehab Instructions

Stretches:

Pectoralis Minor Stretching:

1. Place your elbow and forearm against a doorframe or corner with your elbow just below shoulder height. Stay tall and don't bend over.
2. Move forward until you feel a comfortable stretch across the front of your shoulder and chest.
3. Hold the stretch for 30 seconds.
4. You can repeat this stretch at the different angles shown to target different areas of the shoulder and chest.

Complete 2 sets before moving on to the next stretch and perform 1 x a day.






Sleeper Stretch:



1. Start by lying on your side with the affected arm on the bottom. Bend the elbow to a 90-degree angle.
2. Next, use your opposite hand to gently draw your affected forearm towards the table or bed until you feel a mild stretch.
3. Hold the stretch for 30 seconds

Complete 2 sets before moving on to the strength exercises and perform 1 x a day.

Strengthening:

No Money:





1. Hold a resistance band with your palms facing up.
2. Keep your elbows locked at your side and bent at a 90-degree angle.
3. Rotate your arms out while squeezing your shoulder blades together and pulling them down, as if you're "tucking them into your back pockets."

Complete 3 sets of 15 reps perform 1 x a day.

Pushup Plus (shown on wall):





1. Lean forward against a wall, engage your core, and do a push-up.
2. At the top of the pushup, continue to push your upper back away from the wall. This will cause your shoulder blades to round slightly. This is a very subtle movement, and you'll only move a few inches or less.
3. To increase the difficulty and progress, do the push-ups against a countertop, then against a couch, and, eventually, on the floor.
4. Complete 3 sets of 10 reps 1 x a day.



Practical Tips for Success:

- Keep your shoulders rolled back and down, as if you're "tucking them into your back pockets" when performing these exercises.
- Keep your movements slow and smooth as you do these exercises.
- Expect to do these rehab exercises for 4–8 weeks
- If you participate in a throwing sport, work on strengthening your core and your lower body.

References

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